

THE SOLUTION BOOK

LIVE AUTOMATION SYSTEM

One worked build – follow along.

One fully worked build, so you can see what “finished” looks like — three little automations that run together and save real time.

YOU'LL USE THESE SIX THINGS

Scheduled

Routines

Connectors

Projects

Skills

Zapier / n8n

WHAT, WHY, WHERE, WHEN & HOW

Before we build, here's the whole assignment in five plain-English lines.

WHAT

You build **3 little automations** that run together — a **Schedule** (runs on a clock), a **Routine** (runs when you call it), and an **external Zap** (one app fires → Claude does a step → another app gets the result).

WHY

So the boring, repeating work happens *without you*. Set it up once and it keeps working — even while you sleep.

WHERE

Schedules and Routines live in Claude (left strip → **Scheduled**, and your saved routines); the Zap lives in **Zapier** or **n8n** and calls Claude.

WHEN

Build them once. The Schedule runs on its clock, the Routine runs whenever you call it, the Zap runs whenever its trigger fires.

HOW

Pick **3 different real problems**. Make one a Schedule (run it 3 days, keep Day 1 vs Day 3), one a Routine (input template → prompt chain → fixed output), one an external Zap (Trigger → Claude step → Output). Then map all three.

YOUR TOOLBOX

Six things live inside Claude. Here are the first three — the set-up tools.



Customize

[Left strip → Customize](#)

The settings room. This is where you switch apps and skills on.

- 1 Click **Customize** in the left strip.
- 2 You'll see **Connectors** (your apps) and **Skills** (your saved tricks).
- 3 Turn things on here first, then use them in a chat.

Like this — Like the settings menu in a video game — you set things up before you play.



Connectors

[Customize → Connectors](#)

A plug that lets Claude see ONE of your apps, like your Calendar or email.

- 1 Customize → **Connectors** → tap +.
- 2 Find your app, tap **Connect**, sign in and tap **Allow**.
- 3 In a chat, tap + → Connectors → switch it **on** for that chat.

Like this — Like plugging a lamp into the wall. Plug in once; flick the switch when you want light. (Claude never sees your password.)



Skills

[Type / in the chat](#)

A saved instruction you call by name. The name IS the command.

- 1 To use one, type / then its name, e.g. **/meeting-notes**.
- 2 To make one, ask Claude to “save this as a skill” and give it a short name.
- 3 Now you can call that trick any time with /.

Like this — Like a cheat-code you type to instantly do a trick, instead of explaining it every time.

YOUR TOOLBOX — PART 2

And the three you build *with* — **Scheduled** is the timer that makes this whole assignment tick.



Projects

Left strip → Projects

A folder that remembers. Everything inside shares the same memory.

- 1 Left strip → **Projects** → **New project** → name it “My Workflow Map”.
- 2 Add notes or files with **Upload**; turn on the connectors you need.
- 3 Do all your assignment chats *inside* the project so nothing is forgotten.

Like this — Like a school binder for one subject — all the right pages in one place.



Artifacts

Appears on the right when Claude builds

The thing Claude makes that you keep — a doc, a table, a little app, or your map.

- 1 Ask Claude to “make this as an Artifact.”
- 2 It opens on the right — you can edit it and it saves.
- 3 Your finished workflow map will be an Artifact.

Like this — Like your finished drawing you pin on the wall — a real thing you can keep and show.



Scheduled

Left strip → Scheduled

Jobs on a timer that run all by themselves.

- 1 Left strip → **Scheduled** → **New task**.
- 2 Say the job in plain words and pick how often (daily / weekly).
- 3 To stop it later: Scheduled → **Pause** or delete.

Like this — Like an alarm clock, but for tasks — it wakes up and does the job without you.

CONNECT TWO APPS (EXAMPLES)

A connector plugs one of your apps into Claude, so your automations can use your real data. Two good ones for this assignment:

Google Sheets

So Claude can read and write your data — perfect for the “Claude for Data” task and a Zap that logs results.

- 1 Customize → Connectors → + → find **Google Sheets** → **Connect**.
- 2 Sign in and tap **Allow**.
- 3 In a chat: + → Connectors → turn **Sheets** on.
- 4 Try it: “Read the latest row of my Sales sheet and summarise it.”

Gmail

So an automation can send you (or a customer) the finished output — like a daily summary email.

- 1 Customize → Connectors → + → find **Gmail** → **Connect** → **Allow**.
- 2 In a chat: + → Connectors → turn **Gmail** on.
- 3 Try it: “Email me a 3-line summary of today’s numbers.”
- 4 You review anything before it sends.

Safety — Claude never sees your password, and an automation should never send or change anything you haven’t set up and checked.

USE TWO SKILLS (EXAMPLES)

A skill is a saved rule-set you call with /. These two make great Routines — call them and they run the same way every time.

/daily-brief

Turns your inputs into a fixed morning brief — the same shape every day.

- 1 Ask Claude: "Save this as a skill called daily-brief."
- 2 Give it the fixed output shape (focus, risks, first task).
- 3 Type **/daily-brief** and paste your calendar + goals.
- 4 You get the same tidy Today card each morning.

/clean-data

Tidies messy rows or notes into a clean table, the same way each time.

- 1 Save it with your cleaning rules (columns, formats).
- 2 Type **/clean-data** and paste the mess.
- 3 You get a clean table back.
- 4 It won't invent values — gaps are marked, not guessed.

Tip — No skill yet? Ask Claude: "Save this as a skill called daily-brief." Next time, **/daily-brief** runs it. The name IS the command.

THE THREE AUTOMATIONS

Your assignment ships three *kinds* of automation. Here's what each one is — pick a different real problem for each.

SCHEDULE

Runs on a clock — daily or weekly. Set it and forget it.

ROUTINE

Runs when you call it — an input template + fixed steps + a fixed output.

EXTERNAL ZAP

Runs when another app fires — Trigger → a Claude step → an Output elsewhere.

A worked trio (example)

Schedule — every morning at 8am Claude reads yesterday's sales row from Google Sheets and emails me a 3-line summary (I ran it 3 days; Day 3 was noticeably sharper than Day 1). **Routine** — /daily-brief: I paste my calendar + top 3 goals, it returns a fixed "Today" card (focus, risks, first task). **External Zap** — when a new row lands in my "Leads" sheet, Zapier sends it to Claude, which scores the lead and writes the score back to the sheet. Three different problems, three kinds of automation.

WRITE THE PROMPTS THE **STAR** WAY

Every automation runs a prompt. Good prompts follow **STAR** — Situation, Task, Action, Result. Write one for each of your three.

S**Situation**

What's going on.

T**Task**

The one job.

A**Action**

The rules.

R**Result**

What you want back.

Schedule · daily summary

- S** Every morning I need yesterday's numbers digested.
- T** Summarise yesterday's sales row.
- A** Read the latest row from the Sheet; 3 lines; flag anything down >10%; never invent a number.
- R** A 3-line email I can read in 10 seconds.

Routine · /daily-brief

- S** I start the day scattered.
- T** Turn my inputs into a Today card.
- A** From my calendar + 3 goals, give focus, top risks, and the first task; keep the same shape daily.
- R** A short, fixed Today card.

Zap · lead scoring

- S** New leads land in my sheet all day.
- T** Score each new lead.
- A** Rate fit 1–5 against my ideal-customer rules; one-line reason; write it back to the row; email no one.
- R** A score + reason in the sheet.

YOUR AUTOMATION STACK MAP

This is what you hand in — proof all three run. For each system: the problem it solves and the time it saves.



A Schedule

time-triggered; ran 3 days
(Day 1 vs Day 3)

Daily 8am sales-summary email — Day 3 sharper than Day 1



A Routine

input template → prompt
chain → fixed output

/daily-brief — paste inputs, get a fixed Today card



An external Zap

Trigger → Claude step →
Output

New lead row → Claude scores → written back to Sheet

THE PROBLEM EACH SOLVES + TIME SAVED

1. Schedule — no manual morning number-crunching (~15 min/day)
2. Routine — no scattered start; same brief in 1 click (~10 min/day)
3. Zap — leads scored the moment they arrive (~20 min/day)

WHAT TO SUBMIT

One **Claude Artifact** — an Automation Stack Map: all three systems, the problem each solves, and the time saved. This is **Portfolio asset #3**.

NOW BUILD IT IN CLAUDE

Here's the order to build your own automation stack.

- 1 Pick **3 different real problems** — one for each automation type.
- 2 Build the **Schedule** (left strip → Scheduled → New task); run it 3 days.
- 3 Build the **Routine** — an input template + fixed steps + a fixed output.
- 4 Build the **external Zap** in Zapier/n8n: Trigger → a Claude step → Output.
- 5 Map all three as one **Artifact**; note the problem + time saved for each.

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE — GRADING

- ✓ Three **different** automations: a Schedule, a Routine, and an external Zap.
- ✓ The Schedule was **actually run** (Day 1 vs Day 3 shown).
- ✓ The Routine has a **fixed input template** AND a fixed output shape.
- ✓ The Zap is a real **Trigger** → **Claude step** → **Output**.
- ✓ Each solves a **different real problem**, with time saved noted.

YOU'RE DONE WHEN

- ☐ A Schedule, a Routine and an external Zap — three different problems.
- ☐ The Schedule ran 3 days (Day 1 vs Day 3 kept).
- ☐ All three on one Stack Map, saved as an Artifact.

COMMON MISSES TO FLAG

- ✗ Three versions of the same automation type.
- ✗ A Schedule set up but never run.
- ✗ "Routine" is just a one-off chat — no fixed template/output.
- ✗ No honest time saved, or invented numbers.

That's a real automation stack — work that happens while you sleep. It feeds straight into your Session 4 capstone.

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Your turning point in the AI era.